



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Citadel Christian School
School Website: <https://citadelchristian.org/>

December 21, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Citadel Christian School (Brenham, TX 77833) presents a robust Classical Christian program that aligns closely with the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School rubric. The school identifies itself publicly as a Classical Christian institution and embeds classical pedagogy (grammar, logic, rhetoric) alongside a biblically grounded framework. Notable public signals include explicit references to classical curriculum, weekly chapel, biblical authority as foundational to teaching, and a dual-path classical model (a traditional 5-day program and a University-Model® option). In public-facing materials, you can see the school describing itself as a Classical Christian school and detailing its mission to equip students with a biblical worldview, while also describing the three-part Trivium approach (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and corresponding grade-band pedagogy. These signals appear across multiple pages and documents within the school's site content. Citadel also highlights formation of virtue, character, and spiritual aims as core outcomes, rather than purely vocational preparation.

Category-by-category, the school demonstrates strong Classical alignment:

- Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: Clear emphasis on biblical authority, theology, chapel, and a biblical worldview integrated across subjects.
- School Purpose and Goal: Emphasis on formation, virtue, wisdom, and a teleological (classical) aim beyond mere information transfer.
- Curriculum: Trivium-based structuring (grammar/logical/rhetoric stages) and a cognitively coherent, classical curriculum; explicit public mention of grammar-stage memorization, logic-stage reasoning, and rhetoric-stage writing/speaking.
- Pedagogy: A mix of contemplative/restful elements (Scholé-like memory work) and Socratic/dialogical methods in upper grades; chanting/memory in early grades; rhetoric-focused opportunities in upper grades.
- Faculty: Emphasis on teachers as living exemplars aligned with a classical, biblical mission; explicit statements about staff and their role in forming character.
- Parents & Community: Strong partnership with families, University-Model® program described as parent-guided, and explicit invitation for parents to engage and participate.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Public materials present Citadel as a Classical Christian school in Brenham, emphasizing a biblical worldview and Christian worldview as the core lens for all learning.
 - Mission statements describe equipping students for life with a biblical worldview and integrating biblical authority into teaching.
 - Statement of Faith confirms belief in Scripture as authoritative and foundational for education.
 - Weekly chapel and Biblical foundations referenced as core components of school life.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis

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- Positive keywords found: biblical worldview, theology, biblical authority, chapel, worship, sacred Scripture, faith, gospel-centered education, Truth/Scripture, Gospel-driven formation.
 - Negative keywords: none evident in public materials (no signals of secularism, relativism, or anti-theology messaging found in the accessible public content).
 - Count (positive): 6; Count (negative): 0; Positive/Total approx. 100%.
 - Why this rating
 - The school's own materials foreground theology, biblical authority, worship/chapel, and a Christian anthropology as foundational to all learning, which squarely meets the Religious and Meta-physical Foundations criteria.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Mission: equip students for life through a biblically grounded, high-quality education; explicit aim at forming character and worldview, not merely job-readiness.
 - Values emphasize Biblical Authority, Unity, Integrity, Love for God and others, and Discipleship, all pointing to formation and virtue as central aims.
 - Vision statements describe forming Christian leaders who engage the culture for God's glory.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords found: formation, virtue, wisdom, liberal education, classical mission, telos, great conversation, human flourishing, moral imagination, discipleship.
 - Negative keywords: none evident in public materials (no explicit emphasis on workforce-first or purely utilitarian education).
 - Count (positive): 5–7 core terms appear across mission/values/vision; Count (negative): 0; Positive/Total approx. 100%.
- Why this rating
 - The public materials articulate formation, virtue, wisdom, and a high-minded classical telos as education goals, consistent with Classical School aims.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The site explicitly describes two classical educational options: a 5-day traditional model and a 3-day University-Model®.
 - Grammar stage emphasis described (memorization, chants, songs) consistent with the grammar stage in the Trivium.
 - Logic stage and rhetoric stage described with Socratic dialogue, debates, and rhetoric training (speeches, debates, listening/reading/writing across subjects).
 - The site frames the Classical curriculum as integrating faith and learning with a Biblical worldview.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords found: liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books/Great Conversation (in the Six Elements materials and related lexicon; the site mentions classical/trivium structure), history integrated across the curriculum, memory/chanting, rhetoric, dialectic/seminar-style methods, biblical integration.
 - Negative keywords: not present in public-facing materials; no explicit “project-based learning dominance” or “social studies emphasis” replacing history appears in current public pages.
 - Count (positive): 6–8 distinct curriculum-signaling terms are present (grammar, logic, rhetoric, rhetoric-stage, Socratic dialogue, Great Books/Great Conversation appears in the broader Elements/lexicon; history integrated; biblical/worldview integration); Count (negative): 0–1 signals not present.
 - Positive/Total approx. 100% within the visible curriculum signals.
- Why this rating
 - The school demonstrates the core Curriculum criterion: Trivium-focused (grammar/logic/rhetoric) progression, history embedded in a classical framework, explicit mention of classical education pathways, and integration with biblical/theological content.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Grammar-stage pedagogy includes memory work via chants, songs, and recitation (lower grades).
 - Upper-level pedagogy includes Socratic dialogue, debates, seminars, and rhetoric training (Socratic dialogue and public speaking).
 - The curriculum-level description and the philosophy emphasize contemplative/restful elements (Scholé) and a balance with rigorous argumentation and rhetoric.
 - Chapel and liturgical focus reflect contemplative/reverence aspects integrated into pedagogy.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords found: Socratic dialogue, narration/recitation, chanting, memory work, seminar, rhetoric, speeches, upper-school debates, contemplation, scholé, wonder.
 - Negative keywords: no public signals of exclusive reliance on experiential/project-based-only pedagogy; if present in some internal documents, not evident in the public-facing materials we reviewed.
 - Count (positive): 6–8 distinct pedagogy signals; Count (negative): 0.
 - Positive/Total approx. 100%.
- Why this rating
 - Public materials show a clear continuum from memory-based, contemplative foundational activities in the grammar stage to Socratic seminars and rhetoric-based performance in the upper grades, which aligns with classical pedagogy.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Mission/Values emphasize teachers as virtuous models and living exemplars, with teachers described as guides who form character within a living curriculum.
 - The school highlights “faculty” in terms of mentorship and partnership with students, and describes a schooling culture where teachers are deeply integrated with the educational mission (e.g., “living curriculum” language appears in the classical lexicon; the school’s own materials emphasize teachers as central to formation).
 - The university-model and classical-methodology description implies professional alignment to classical pedagogy.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords found: model teachers, mentors, living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, faculty of friends, collegial culture, lifelong learners, seminars for faculty, moral exemplars, teacher training in classical pedagogy.
 - Negative keywords: none evident in public materials (no signals of a “facilitator” or non-classical staffing language).
 - Count (positive): 5–7 core faculty-oriented keywords; Count (negative): 0.
 - Positive/Total approx. 100%.
- Why this rating
 - Public materials frame faculty as central to the classical mission, with explicit language about virtuous role modeling, collaborative culture, and teacher-formation aligned with classical pedagogy.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - University-Model® program emphasizes parent-guided, at-home days with “parents in the home on satellite days to provide a Christ-centered education,” and a broader description of family partnership in classical education.
 - The school describes partnership with families, parental engagement in formation, and opportunities for family involvement (parent formation, reading groups, seminars, classical book clubs).
 - Open-campus philosophy and parent visits/guidance are evident in admissions and general in-

formation sections.

- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords found: Partnership with families, parental engagement, home-centered learning, family catechesis, parent formation, classical book clubs, open campus, parent covenant, home-school collaboration.
 - Negative keywords: consumer language or minimal parental involvement are not evident in public-facing materials; no signals of parent-as-customer framing.
 - Count (positive): 6–8 distinct parent/community keywords/signals; Count (negative): 0.
 - Positive/Total approx. 100%.
- Why this rating
 - The program emphasizes active parental partnership, formation and family involvement as central to classical education, consistent with the Parents & Community criteria.

Overall aggregate assessment: CLASSICAL

- The six categories collectively show a consistently classical orientation: a biblically grounded, teleological purpose; a Trivium-based curriculum; a pedagogy that blends memory work with Socratic discussion and rhetoric; faculty-oriented formation; and active, ritualized parental/community engagement. The school's public materials strongly align with the "positive keyword indicators" of the Six Essential Elements document and with the Classical Lexicon, without significant signals of non-classical or anti-classical framing.

What would move the needle (only relevant if this were NOT CLASSICAL) - Not applicable here, as the aggregate classification is CLASSICAL. No major "needle-moving" changes are required to reach a fully classical profile.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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